

For new teachers of K-2 English learners

Every young reader deserves a confident teacher.

Find vetted literacy resources and get friendly, source-backed ideas from Leo, our AI reading coach, made for new teachers helping young English learners learn to read.

Browse resources

Ask Leo



How Literacy Lion works

Two ways in, one trusted collection underneath.



1. Browse the library

Search or filter vetted resources by grade and topic. Hover for a summary, then open the original in a new tab.



2. Ask Leo

Describe a classroom moment. Leo suggests materials and strategies from Literacy Lion's approved resources and curriculum.



3. Check the source

Every answer lists the resources behind it, so you can read them yourself and make the final call.



OUR MISSION

New teachers shouldn't have to guess. We turn trusted literacy research into clear next steps for the students in front of them, while teachers stay in charge.

TODAY'S LITERACY TIP

Sample · changes daily

Pre-teach key words with a picture and a gesture.

Before a read-aloud, introduce three to five essential words with an image and a simple motion. Multilingual learners get a visual and physical anchor for each word before they meet it in the story.

Find related resources →



Safe for your classroom



Answers only from approved Literacy Lion resources and curriculum, never the open web.



Shows the source behind every suggestion.



Won't accept student names or other personal information.



Stays on teaching and literacy topics.

What teachers are saying

“[Teacher quote collected during user testing]”



[Name]
[Role, school]

“[Teacher quote collected during user testing]”



[Name]
[Role, school]

“[Teacher quote collected during user testing]”



[Name]
[Role, school]

IN PARTNERSHIP WITH

Penn State Abington



Solis-Cohen Elementary School

Part of a grant-funded research initiative



literacylion.

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[Project contact email]



Resource library

Vetted literacy resources for K–2 English learners. Hover a card for its summary, then open the original in a new tab.

Search resources

Sort by



Try “phonics”, “read-aloud”, or “sentence frames”

Most relevant



Grade

K

1st

2nd

Topic



Phonics



Vocabulary



Fluency



Comprehension



Oral language



Writing

Type



Strategy



Lesson



Article



Video

Clear filters

Showing 9 of [N] resources

Phonics

Strategy · K–2

Phonics routines for multilingual learners

[Source]

Open

Vocabulary

Strategy · K–1

Teaching vocabulary with visuals and gestures

[Source]

Open

Vocabulary

Article · 1–2

Using cognates to build word knowledge

[Source]

Open

Comprehension

Lesson · K–2

Interactive read-aloud planning guide

[Source]

Open

Oral language

Strategy · K–2

Sentence frames for academic talk

[Source]

Open

Fluency

Strategy · 1–2

Building fluency with repeated reading

[Source]

Open

Phonics

Video · K

Phonemic awareness warm-ups

[Source]

Open

Writing

Article · 1–2

Supporting early writers learning English

[Source]

Open

Comprehension

Strategy · K–2

Checking understanding with low language demands

[Source]

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Leo
LITERACY PLANNING ASSISTANT

Plan with an assistant that shows its sources.

Leo answers planning questions using only Literacy Lion's vetted resources and curriculum, and cites every source it draws on.

- ✓ Grounded in approved curriculum
- ✓ Sources cited with every answer
- ✓ No student information required

Sign in to Leo

Leo is available to teachers in the partnership program.
Your program coordinator provides access codes.

Access code

Continue

No code yet? See [how to get access](#). The [resource library](#) is open to everyone.



+ New chat

RECENT

- Phonics support, Mandarin speaker

Today
- Vocabulary before a read-aloud

Yesterday
- Small-group fluency plan

Mon
- Sentence frames for partner talk

Last week

New chat

Answers from Literacy Lion resources only



Leo · Literacy planning assistant

What are you planning today?

Describe the grade, the skill, and your students' home languages. Leo suggests strategies and materials from approved resources and cites each source.

TRY A STARTING POINT

Phonics

A Mandarin-speaking kindergartener is struggling with phonics. Where do I start?

Vocabulary

How do I pre-teach vocabulary before a read-aloud?

Fluency

What is a quick fluency routine for a small group of 1st graders?

Oral language

Give me sentence frames for partner talk in 2nd grade.

Sources

The resources behind Leo's answers will show up here.

Tips for a useful answer

- Mention the grade level.
- Share the student's home language.
- Say what you've already tried.
- Leave out names and personal details.

Your sessions are private to your account.

Describe the situation: grade, home language, and what you've tried.



Describe the situation, not the student. Leave out names and other personal details.



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Phonics support, Mandarin speaker

Answers from Literacy Lion resources only

One of my Mandarin-speaking kindergarteners is struggling with phonics. How do I help them understand the concept?

Leo · 3 sources cited

Here's a starting point from Literacy Lion's phonics resources:

1. **Focus on sounds that work differently.** Mandarin syllables mostly end in a vowel or a nasal sound, so final consonants like the /t/ in *cat* are often dropped. Practice them in short word lists. [1]
2. **Use minimal pairs.** Contrast words that differ by one sound, like *light* / *right*, with picture cards for a few minutes each day. [2]
3. **Connect sound to print.** Once your student hears the difference, have them build the words with letter tiles. [1] [3]

Adjust based on how your student responds.

ConvHelpfulNot helpful

Phonics warm-up ideas

Vocabulary for a read-aloud

Sentence frames for partner talk

Describe the situation: grade, home language, and what you've tried.



Describe the situation, not the student. Leave out names and other personal details.

Sources

Resources Leo used for this answer.

1 Phonics · Strategy · K–2

Phonics routines for multilingual learners

[Relevant excerpt from the resource]

View in library →

2 Phonics · Video · K

Phonemic awareness warm-ups

[Relevant excerpt from the resource]

View in library →

3 Curriculum

[Curriculum unit, K foundational skills]

[Relevant excerpt from the resource]

View in library →

Your sessions are private to your account.

About us

A friendly place to turn when you're new to teaching reading.

Teaching young children to read is hard. It gets harder when students are still learning English and you're early in your career. Literacy Lion brings trusted guidance into one place, so new teachers never have to figure it out alone.



Our mission

Help new and pre-service teachers turn literacy research into clear decisions about materials and strategies for the English learners in their classroom.

Our vision

Every new teacher of young multilingual readers has a curriculum-grounded starting point, while their own judgment stays in charge.

The partnership

Literacy Lion is part of the grant-funded research project *Supporting Multilingual Reading Development Through School–University Partnerships and Human-Centered AI Tools*, a collaboration between Penn State Abington and Solis-Cohen Elementary School in Philadelphia.

Resources are chosen to align with evidence-based literacy practice and the School District of Philadelphia's English Language Arts curriculum.



Penn State Abington

Research lead and teacher preparation



Solis-Cohen Elementary School

Partner school serving K–2 English learners

Founders



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Built by

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Timothy Karhna-Glasby
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Eddie Heller
[Role]



Vladislava Melnichuk
[Role]



Jason Coffey
[Role]



Jason Baffour
[Role]



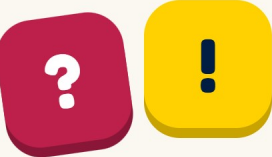
Jooyoung Yoo
[Role]



Israel Molethu
[Role]



Sarnel Brgulja
[Role]



Questions? We've got answers.

Quick answers about the library, Leo, and how we keep things private.

Still wondering about something?

Reach the project team at [Project contact email].

- 1

What is the Literacy Lion?

▼
- 2

Who is Literacy Lion for?

▼
- 3

How do I get an access code to chat with Leo?

▼
- 4

Where do Leo's answers come from?

▲

Only from resources and curriculum stored in Literacy Lion. Leo doesn't search the web, and each answer lists the sources it used so you can read them yourself.
- 5

Can I include details about my students?

▼
- 6

Does Leo replace my judgment?

▼
- 7

Is the content aligned with district curriculum?

▼
- 8

What won't Leo help with?

▼



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[Project contact email]

Draft for client review

Effective [DATE]

Terms & Privacy

The short version: use Literacy Lion to support your teaching, keep student information out of Leo, and treat its ideas as a starting point.

On this page

Using Literacy Lion

Access to Leo

Student privacy

What we collect

AI limitations

Changes and contact

1

Using Literacy Lion

Literacy Lion supports literacy instruction for young English learners. Linked resources belong to their original publishers and open on their own sites; their terms apply there.

2

Access to Leo

Leo is limited to participants in the partnership program. Keep your access code to yourself. Access may be removed if Leo is used for purposes unrelated to teaching.

3

Student privacy

Do not enter student names, photos, records or other information that could identify a student. Describe the teaching situation instead, for example the grade, home language and skill. Leo is designed to decline prompts that include personal information.

4

What we collect

[Describe what is stored (for example chat sessions and account details), where it is stored, how long it is kept, who can see it, and whether it is used for research. To be confirmed with the client and university policy.]

5

AI limitations

Leo answers from Literacy Lion's approved resources, but it can still misread a question or a source. Check the cited resources and use your professional judgment before acting on a suggestion.

6

Changes and contact

We may update these terms as the project develops and will note the effective date above. Questions: [Project contact email].



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Logo directions



A Book mane

**Literacy Lion**
Penn State Abington

**Literacy Lion**



B Speech bubble

**Literacy Lion**
Penn State Abington

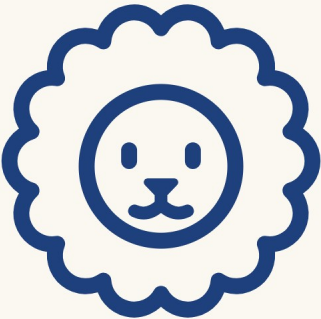
**Literacy Lion**



C Letter block

**Literacy Lion**
Penn State Abington

**Literacy Lion**



D Line mark

**Literacy Lion**
Penn State Abington

**Literacy Lion**

E Wordmark only

literacylion.

literacylion.

D + E combined

**literacylion.**
PENN STATE ABINGTON

**literacylion.**
PENN STATE ABINGTON


literacylion.

